



**GENDER IN
HUMANITARIAN ACTION
WORKING GROUP
UKRAINE**

**Gender in Humanitarian Action Working Group
Meeting Minutes**

Time: 14:00 - 15:30

Date: June 03, 2025

Venue: online & 9B Mykhailo Hrushevsky Street, Parkova Doroga, Kyiv, 01021,
Ukraine

Agenda:

1. Results of the Monitoring of Women's Rights (2022–2025) by the National Network Women's Consortium of Ukraine
2. Key insights from the global Women Deliver conference in Naarm (Melbourne)
3. Documenting and Investigating Crimes Against LGBTIQ+ Individuals in Situations of Armed Conflict by NGO PROJECTOR

All presentations and material are available at the link:

<https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/17me8FppufAKLPOEfclhPa9Zp76QkfHqW>

1. Results of the Monitoring of Women's Rights (2022–2025) by the National Network Women's Consortium of Ukraine, Larysa Magdyuk

Larysa Magdyuk presented the findings outlined in the analytical report on the monitoring of women's rights for 2022–2025. During the monitoring process, more than 50 female respondents participated in surveys and focus groups. The key objective of the monitoring was to assess how Ukraine's obligations under the CEDAW Convention are being fulfilled during the war. Nine articles of the Convention were selected for monitoring. The main point highlighted in the report is that women's rights cannot be viewed in isolation from the broader context of the challenges associated with the war in Ukraine.

The first set of challenges identified by the monitoring concerns the care crisis. Women continue to bear the primary burden of caring for their families, children, elderly relatives, veterans, and the wounded. As a result, many of them are excluded from the labor market. The second set of challenges is unequal access to services. In many regions of Ukraine,

access to services - especially medical services - and infrastructure is limited. ID women often remain isolated in the communities to which they have moved, despite the existence of support programs. The third set of challenges is economic isolation or even exclusion. These are circumstances that force women to take lower-paying jobs that may not even be related to their education or previous experience. The fourth set of challenges is invisible vulnerability. These are cases of domestic and GBV that often remain unseen.

The first area addressed in the analytical report is the realization of women's rights in political life. The report notes the purely formal nature of gender quotas, the inability of women to participate in the country's political life due to their experiences of displacement, the insufficient participation of female military personnel, and barriers related to discrimination. The next area is civic activism, where women were the most active volunteers at the start of the full-scale war. However, as government and tax controls increased, the level of volunteering declined. Legislation on volunteering is not geared toward supporting women's volunteering. The instability of funding for women's organizations and the overburdening of women also pose challenges. A new issue that has emerged is physical and emotional exhaustion. In the field of education, the main challenge is online education and learning losses. In the health sector, the biggest challenge is the lack of information for women about their medical rights and options, as well as the lack of systematic attention to women's mental health issues. In the socio-economic sphere, the problem is a lack of jobs and resulting long-term unemployment among women, particularly for IDPs, as well as insufficient opportunities for retraining and flexible employment.

Another section of the report addresses temporary special measures and protection during maternity. Damage to medical infrastructure is affecting women's access to health care services. A new and significant issue is the lack of legal options for civil partnerships.

The issue of human trafficking receives special attention in the monitoring. Due to the war, migration, and economic vulnerability, the risk of human trafficking for women and children is increasing.

Regarding issues related to gender-based violence against women, there are gaps in legislation, and insufficient coordination among all responders and available specialists. There is stigma and mistrust of institutions on the part of victims. Society exhibits tolerance toward GBV and discrimination. The number of cyberviolence cases is rising, and there is a lack of response mechanisms.

2. Key Takeaways from the Women Deliver Global Conference in Naarm (Melbourne), Milena Goryachkovska

Milena Goryachkovska shared her experience of attending the Women Deliver conference.

The conference brings together up to 12,000 participants from around the world and has a less formal atmosphere. It tends to address the pressing issues highlighted by the women's movement. This year, there were 6,000 participants, 3% of whom were from Europe. There were three representatives from Ukraine. A major focus of this year's conference was on the

rights of indigenous peoples, decolonization, and climate justice with an intersectional approach.

Feminist approaches to the use of artificial intelligence were also discussed at the conference. Somewhat less attention was paid to the topics of women's economic empowerment, combating gender-based violence, and the rights of women with disabilities.

There was almost no coverage of Agenda 1325 Women, Peace, and Security or the UN Security Council, which is very different from the discussions taking place in Ukraine. According to Milena's observations, the international community is aware of events in Ukraine, but they remain on the periphery of the discourse. Much more attention was paid to events in Gaza. In addition, other wars were also discussed.

At this conference, the so-called Melbourne Declaration on Gender Equality was approved. It is a visionary document preceded by lengthy interregional consultations.

Milena shared some links that might be useful in the context of our discussion about the Conference:

- Declaration on Gender Equality
<https://womendeliver.org/wd2026/melbourne-declaration-for-gender-equality/>
- The Issue of Adolescent Girls
<https://womendeliver.org/the-adolescent-girls-era/>
- Manifesto of Adolescent Girls
<https://womendeliver.org/wp-content/uploads/2026/04/Girls-Deliver-Manifesto-En-041326.pdf>
- Statement by Indigenous Women
<https://womendeliver.org/publications/first-nations-indigenous-women-statement/>
- Charter for a Feminist Health System
<https://womendeliver.org/publications/feminist-health-systems-charter/>

3. Documenting and Investigating Crimes Against LGBTIQ+ Individuals in Situations of Armed Conflict by NGO PROJECTOR, Vitalii Matvieiev

Vitaliy Matveev shared insights into the work of the NGO PROJECTOR in documenting and investigating war crimes against LGBTIQ+ individuals. The organization has recorded over 250 cases in which members of the LGBTIQ+ community have served as witnesses, eyewitnesses, or victims since 2023. The community faces war crimes directly linked to SOGI or people's physical appearance or representation in society. Russian military personnel single out such individuals and subject them to additional criminal acts.

The community rarely turns to the Ukrainian law enforcement system because there were already issues with the system's response to reports even before the full-scale invasion. Since reports from the LGBTIQ+ community were not singled out in any way, it is impossible to collect statistical data on their number or the number of victims. The number of cases of war crimes has increased significantly. To date, there are only 9 officially recognized cases. These

are 9 people who agreed to speak publicly about having been victims of war crimes committed by Russian military personnel.

The NGO PROJECTOR has developed a guide containing recommendations on the specific aspects of investigating crimes against LGBTQI+ individuals in situations of armed conflict.

Action points:

1. Read the report on the results of the monitoring of women's rights
2. Share information about the [UWF travel grant competition](#) for women activists and take advantage of this opportunity if needed
3. Use [the guide](#) from the NGO PROJECTOR and share information about it and [the app](#) for victims developed by the organization